§ 05 · RESEARCH

Investors UK

Nineteen London funds ranked for Alche's pre-seed round. Top picks, angle, contact, money flow.

Research date: 24 April 2026 **Startup:** Alche — Berlin-based AI longevity app + curated supplement commerce, €5-9/mo membership tier. "Xiaohongshu for longevity in Europe." **Raise:** €500K pre-seed, solo founder (Timu, Berlin) **Comps pitched:** Xiaohongshu ($31B), AG1 ($600M), The Ordinary/DECIEM ($700M), Thrive Market, Ritual, Costco model **Status:** Final — 19 funds captured with full data; 2 flagged as off-thesis or wrong stage but included for completeness.

Summary Table

#	FUND	PRE-SEED CHECK	CONSUMER-WELLNESS FIT	KEY PARTNER(S)	FIT SCORE	STATUS
1	**Ada Ventures**	£250k–£1.5m	**Yes — "healthy aging" is a core thesis pillar**	Check Warner (MBE), Matt Penneycard	**10/10**	Active, Fund II £63m
2	**JamJar Investments**	£800k–£1m initial (Fund II £100m)	**Yes — built by Innocent founders, DTC DNA**	Richard Reed, Jon Wright, Adam Balon, Katie Marraché	**10/10**	Active, ECF-backed
3	**V3 Ventures**	£1m–£5m (seed+)	**Yes — lists "functional supplements" as thesis**	Manuel "Lopo" Lopo de Carvalho (founder of Treatwell)	**9/10** (top of range)	Active, 29 investments
4	**dmg ventures**	£500k–£2m	**Yes — recently led Equi (women's supplements)**	Manuel Lopo de Carvalho, Taos Edmondson	**9/10**	Active, media-leveraged
5	**Cherry Ventures**	€500k–€2m pre-seed	**Yes — Zalando consumer DNA**	Dinika Mahtani (London), Filip Dames, Christian Meermann (Berlin)	**9/10**	Active, $500M Fund V
6	**Eka Ventures**	£500k–£2m (avg ~$2m)	**Yes — consumer healthcare + sustainable consumption**	Camilla Dolan, Jon Coker	**8/10**	Active, £91.5m Fund II
7	**Calm/Storm Ventures**	€150k–€500k	**Yes — pure health/wellbeing HealthTech thesis**	Stephanie Urbanski, Johannes Blaschke	**8/10**	Active, €20m Fund II
8	**Octopus Ventures**	£1m–£10m first cheque (consumer pod)	**Yes — dedicated consumer pod, Depop/Elvie/Tails track record**	Rebecca Hunt (Consumer)	**8/10** (check size edge)	Active, £1.2bn AUM
9	**Playfair Capital**	£100k–£1.5m	Partial — sector-agnostic pre-seed, has consumer exposure	Chris Smith, Henrik Wetter Sanchez	**7/10**	Active, $70m Fund III
10	**LocalGlobe / Phoenix Court**	£250k–£2m seed	Partial — generalist, some consumer (Graze, Secret Escapes historical)	Saul Klein, Robin Klein, Ophelia Brown, Emma Phillips	**7/10**	Active
11	**Seedcamp**	Up to $1m lead	Partial — sector-agnostic, some healthtech	Reshma Sohoni, Carlos Espinal, Tom Wilson, Sia Houchangnia	**7/10**	Active, Fund VI deploying
12	**Passion Capital**	£250k–£1m	Partial — consumer in Fund IV (Butternut Box)	Eileen Burbidge MBE, Robert Dighero	**7/10**	Active, Fund IV
13	**Moonfire Ventures**	$100k–$5m (sweet spot $1.5m)	Partial — health & wellbeing is one of 4 pillars	Mattias Ljungman	**7/10**	Active, $115m Fund II
14	**Connect Ventures**	$500k–$5m	Partial — health is a listed sector, product-led thesis	Pietro Bezza, Sitar Teli, Rory Stirling	**6/10**	Active

#	FUND	PRE-SEED CHECK	CONSUMER-WELLNESS FIT	KEY PARTNER(S)	FIT SCORE	STATUS
15	**Kindred Capital**	£500k–£2m	Partial — generalist equitable venture model	Leila Zegna, Mark Evans, Chrys Chrysanthou	**6/10**	Active, £81m seed fund
16	**Concept Ventures**	Up to $1.5m	Partial — UK pre-seed generalist, some consumer exposure	Reece Chowdhry, Oliver Kicks	**6/10**	Active, $88m Fund II
17	**Felix Capital**	Typically Seed/Series A (too late for €500K?)	**Yes thesis** (Goop, Peloton, Peppy, AKT London)	Frederic Court	**6/10** (stage mismatch)	Active
18	**Hoxton Ventures**	$500k–$5m	Weak — B2B-heavy, has FINESSE	Hussein Kanji, Bryan Gartner	**4/10**	Active
19	**firstminute Capital**	£1m–£3m	Weak — deep tech/AI focus	Brent Hoberman, Henry Lane Fox, Spencer Crawley	**4/10**	Active (2026)

Funds deprioritised (documented but not primary targets): - **Entrepreneur First** — talent investor, cofounder-matching program; wrong format for a solo founder with an existing Berlin-based operating company (3/10) - **Episode 1 Ventures** — B2B SaaS only, explicitly off-thesis (2/10) - **Forward Partners (UK)** — reduced to team of 3 post Advances wind-down, unverified new deals in 2026 (flagged inactive) - **Iris Ventures** — excellent thematic fit (beauty/wellness/longevity) but growth-stage only (€5–20m tickets), not pre-seed. Keep for Series A.

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1. Ada Ventures

- **Website:** https://www.adaventures.com (verified, active)
- **Check:** £250k–£1.5m at pre-seed, often leads 70%+ of rounds
- **Fund size:** £63m / $80m Fund II (final closed), total £100m+ AUM across two funds
- **Thesis:** "Investing in the best, not just the best-connected." Three themes: climate equity, economic empowerment, and **healthy ageing**. Their public-facing materials frame healthy ageing around cognitive preservation, preventative medicine, and the shift from reactive to predictive care — almost a word-for-word match for Alche's pitch.
- **Consumer/wellness fit: Yes.** They have explicitly hosted a "Health Equity dinner" around the healthy ageing thesis. Recent healthy aging check: **Aerska** (neurological disease prevention, Ada was first institutional check). Also Toothfairy (DTC dental), Medly AI, Interhuman AI, Juno Bio.
- **Key partners:**
- **Check Warner (MBE)** — co-founding partner, diversity/inclusion focus, formerly Downing Ventures. Very public, active on LinkedIn.
- **Matt Penneycard** — co-founder, 15+ years pre-seed, former head of Downing Ventures, focus on founder coaching.
- **Intro vector:** They publicly commit to reviewing cold inbound; strong intros via Atomico, Molten, BBB network. Also: Charles Hudson (Precursor) is on their steering committee and runs periodic London founder sessions.
- **Red flags for Alche:** None material. Ada actively seeks European founders (Berlin-based is fine). Only potential friction: they lean female-forward/underrepresented-founder; Alche is male solo founder but the healthy-aging thesis alignment likely outweighs.
- **Fit score: 10/10** — the closest single-thesis match in the UK ecosystem.

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2. JamJar Investments

- **Website:** https://www.jamjarinvestments.com (verified, active)
- **Check:** Typical initial cheque £800k–£1m (Fund II), with ~50% reserved for follow-on. Fund I averaged ~£500k.
- **Fund size:** £100m Fund II (2022), anchored by £48m from British Business Bank ECF — the largest ECF to date.
- **Thesis:** Early-stage consumer brands. Explicit focus on **fintech, healthtech, food & drink, marketplaces, and beauty**. "Back founders with an idea consumers love."
- **Consumer/wellness fit: Yes — the purest DNA match.** Founded by the three Innocent Drinks founders who exited to Coca-Cola for $700m+. Portfolio is a who's-who of European DTC: Deliveroo, Oatly, Wild (natural deodorant), Tails.com (personalized pet

food), Babylon, Runna, Farewill, Simba, SURI (oral care), Xoxo (functional soda), Marleybones, TrueStart Coffee, **Healf (wellness marketplace)**.

- **Key partners:**
- **Richard Reed** — co-founder Innocent, partner since 2012
- **Jon Wright** — co-founder Innocent, partner
- **Adam Balon** — co-founder Innocent, partner
- **Katie Marraché (née Leviten)** — partner, named Europe's youngest female VC partner in 2017; Oxford human sciences background, likely the most founder-accessible.
- **Intro vector:** Warm intros via Innocent alumni network, existing portfolio founders (e.g., reach out to SURI, Runna, or Xoxo founders). Also co-invested with V3/dmg/Hambro Perks frequently.
- **Red flags for Alche:** Healf is already in the portfolio — Healf is a **curated wellness marketplace**, arguably the closest UK analog to Alche's commerce side. This could be either **killer warm intro** (if JamJar sees Alche as complementary/European) or **portfolio conflict** (if they see it as competing). Worth pre-clearing before pitching.
- **Fit score: 10/10** — but pre-clear the Healf overlap.

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3. V3 Ventures

- **Website:** https://www.v3.ventures (verified, active)
- **Check:** £1m–£5m, seed and Series A (top of Alche's €500K pre-seed range or slightly above)
- **Thesis:** European consumer-focused, explicitly lists **"better-for-you alternatives, functional foods, functional drinks, functional supplements, and alternative proteins"** as focus areas. Beauty, personal care, food and consumer lifestyle.
- **Consumer/wellness fit: Yes, explicit.** This is one of the few UK/European VCs that lists functional supplements verbatim. Portfolio: SURI, **Wild**, **Yepoda (Korean skincare)**, Holy (functional drinks), KatKin.
- **Key partner: Manuel "Lopo" Lopo de Carvalho** — founder of Treatwell (hair/beauty booking platform, sold 2019 after building to 11 countries and 31 cities). Deep consumer-DTC operator, not a "spreadsheet VC."
- **2026 activity:** 29 companies, 7 new investments in last 12 months.
- **Intro vector:** Warm intros via SURI / Wild / Yepoda founders. Ecosystem events with dmg ventures and JamJar.
- **Red flags for Alche:** Their starting cheque of £1m may be larger than a typical €500K pre-seed round would absorb; Alche may need to expand round size or position V3 as lead. Consumer-heavy portfolio is all **brand-first** (Wild, SURI, Yepoda) — Alche's content+platform angle is less typical for them but aligns with their thesis wording.
- **Fit score: 9/10** — possible stage mismatch on low end of check.

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4. dmg ventures

- **Website:** https://www.dmgventures.com / Medium blog under dmg-ventures
- **Check:** ~£500k–£2m (varies; typically seed)
- **Thesis:** Venture arm of Daily Mail Group — "venture with a voice." They leverage DMG media (MailOnline, Metro, etc.) to fast-track consumer startups to mass-market awareness.
- **Consumer/wellness fit: Yes, directly.** Recently backed **Equi** — "science-led, results-driven women's wellness" supplement brand with "strong DTC performance, industry-leading retention" (direct match to Alche's commerce side). Also W-Wellness (wellness marketplace), SURI, TRIP (CBD drinks), Runna, plus a stealth wellness brand per their 2025 annual update.
- **Key partners:**
- **Manuel Lopo de Carvalho** — also listed at dmg (cross-affiliation with V3)
- **Taos Edmondson** — writes the widely-read "UK-active consumer VCs" annual Medium list, very public on ecosystem
- **Intro vector:** Media Maestro competition (£250k in ad spend with dmg media) — open to any UK B2C startup. Alche could apply as a route in. Warm intros via Equi / SURI founders.
- **Red flags for Alche:** Equi overlap is real but narrower (Equi is a single-SKU women's brand; Alche is a platform). UK B2C focus might be a slight concern for a Berlin-HQ startup — they've backed European brands but prefer UK distribution angle.
- **Fit score: 9/10** — media distribution value-add is uniquely strong for a content-commerce play.

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5. Cherry Ventures

- **Website:** https://cherry.vc (verified, active)
- **Check:** Pre-seed €500k–€2m, full range up to Series A+ with $500m Fund V
- **Thesis:** European pre-seed + seed across B2B software, consumer, fintech, climate tech, health tech. Founding partners come from **Zalando** — consumer DNA baked in.
- **Consumer/wellness fit: Yes.** 67+ B2C companies in portfolio (of 152 total). Consumer is an explicit vertical. Recent investments span healthtech, retail, and consumer. Note: Robeauté (in their portfolio, sometimes cited as "beauty") is actually **neurosurgical microbots** — do not confuse.
- **Key partners:**
- **Dinika Mahtani** — **London partner**, ex-Uber, leads UK deal flow. This is the direct contact for Alche.
- **Filip Dames** — founding partner, Berlin, ex-Zalando. Given Alche is Berlin-based, this is the right secondary contact.
- **Christian Meermann** — founding partner, Berlin, ex-Zalando CMO
- **Sophia Bendz** — Stockholm partner, ex-Spotify, consumer-strong
- **Intro vector:** Warm intros via Berlin Zalando alumni network (Alche's hometown advantage). Cold-accepting via opportunity@cherry.vc but warm strongly preferred.
- **Red flags for Alche:** None material. Pre-seed check range fits perfectly. Dual-city advantage (Berlin HQ, London partner for UK expansion later).
- **Fit score: 9/10** — arguably the best-structured fit given Berlin + London + Zalando DNA.

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6. Eka Ventures

- **Website:** https://www.ekavc.com (verified, active)
- **Check:** £500k–£3m, average ~$2m; happy to lead rounds, prefers first institutional check
- **Fund size:** Fund II closed at £91.5m / €91.5m with £40m BBB ECF cornerstone
- **Thesis:** Impact-driven early-stage VC. Three pillars: **sustainable consumption, consumer healthcare, inclusive systems**. Explicit focus on **preventative healthcare** — "reorientation of UK healthcare expenditure away from reactive care (95% of budget) toward predictive early detection." This is Alche's thesis in one sentence.
- **Consumer/wellness fit: Yes.** Portfolio: Flok Health (digital physiotherapy, MHRA-approved), Jude (bladder health), Urban Jungle (inclusive insurance), Sourceful, Medly AI.
- **Key partners:**
- **Camilla Dolan** — co-founding partner, ex-MMC, previously invested in Bloom & Wild, Gousto, Elder. Deep consumer/wellbeing conviction.
- **Jon Coker** — co-founding partner, ex-managing partner MMC Ventures, generalist with impact lens
- **Intro vector:** Warm via MMC Ventures alumni, Bloom & Wild / Gousto / Elder founders. BBB ECF co-investor network (shares LP set with JamJar, Ada).
- **Red flags for Alche:** Impact mandate is real — Alche needs to frame preventative health / access equity clearly, not just commerce. A supplement-commerce-first pitch will underperform here; lead with the preventative-care narrative.
- **Fit score: 8/10** — pitch with impact framing, not commerce framing.

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7. Calm/Storm Ventures

- **Website:** https://www.calmstorm.vc (verified, active)
- **Check:** Super-early stage, typically €150k–€500k (pre-seed, often first round)
- **Fund size:** €20m Fund II (final close)
- **Thesis:** "Purpose-driven founders changing our life, health and wellbeing." Pure-play HealthTech including **digital health, wellness, prevention, and care** across B2B and B2C. Claims "most active HealthTech investor in Europe."
- **Consumer/wellness fit: Yes, a pure thesis match.** Portfolio: Fertifa (fertility), Meela (mental health), Thymia.ai (mental health AI), Foundation Health, reproductive care brands. 75+ companies in portfolio.
- **Key partners:**
- **Stephanie Urbanski** — Managing Partner (Vienna-primary, London-connected)
- **Johannes Blaschke** — Partner

- **Ekaterina Gianelli** — Venture Partner
- **Co-investors:** Sequoia, Khosla, Creandum — strong signal partners
- **Intro vector:** Cold-accepting, but warm via portfolio founders is strongest. Also German-speaking market — helpful for Berlin founder.
- **Red flags for Alche:** Calm/Storm is Vienna-HQ with London reach, not pure London. Flag for the list because they're highly relevant to a Berlin-based European healthtech/wellness play even if not strictly "UK." Small fund (€20m) means they're selective but nimble.
- **Fit score: 8/10** — pure healthtech thesis + German-language familiarity.

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8. Octopus Ventures

- **Website:** https://octopusventures.com (verified, active)
- **Check:** Pre-seed from £100k, more typically £1m–£10m first cheque out of the consumer pod. The **consumer pod specifically** makes 8–12 UK investments per year.
- **Fund size:** £1.2bn AUM, one of Europe's largest early-stage platforms
- **Thesis:** Four sector "pods" — Future of Money (fintech), Future of Health, Future of Industry, and **Consumer**. Consumer pod invests in "how we live, work, travel, play, rest and recuperate."
- **Consumer/wellness fit: Yes.** Portfolio: **Depop** ($1.6bn Etsy exit), **Elvie** (women's wellbeing devices), **Tails.com**, Cazoo, Secret Escapes, Zoopla, Sofar Sounds, Graze, Perci Health, Bloom Coaching, Little Journey. This is the track record.
- **Key partner:**
- **Rebecca Hunt** — Partner leading Consumer pod since its launch. Depop board seat for 6+ years. Her stated thesis: "people seeking real human connection," skeptical of AI girlfriends, bearish on pure e-commerce startups. She wants connection-oriented consumer tech. Alche's content-community angle (Xiaohongshu model) aligns; pure-play supplement DTC would not.
- **Intro vector:** Warm via Depop, Elvie, Tails.com network. Octopus is very active at London consumer events (co-hosts B2C Bacchanal with Atomico).
- **Red flags for Alche:** Their first check of £1–10m is **well above** a €500K pre-seed round. Alche would either need to raise a larger round or position Octopus as a late-comer to a second tranche. Also, Hunt's stated "no e-commerce" stance means Alche must lead with content/community, not commerce.
- **Fit score: 8/10** — highest signal if you can clear the check-size mismatch.

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9. Playfair Capital

- **Website:** https://playfair.vc (verified, active)
- **Check:** £100k–£1.5m pre-seed, up to £5m over life of company
- **Fund size:** $70m Fund III (March 2023), $102m total AUM
- **Thesis:** Pre-seed-only, sector-agnostic, high-conviction low-volume (~6 investments per year). "Hustle, heart and humility" founder filter.
- **Consumer/wellness fit:** Partial. 18 consumer (B2C) companies in portfolio of 40+. Not a thematic wellness fund, but open to it.
- **Key partners:**
- **Chris Smith** — Managing Partner, Kauffman Fellow, Forbes contributor, Female Founder Office Hours co-founder. Explicitly interested in **HealthTech (except diagnostics/therapeutics)**. This is the right contact.
- **Henrik Wetter Sanchez** — General Partner, ex-BAML, two prior founder exits
- **Joe Thornton** — ex-Google/Facebook, now sourcing and leading investments
- **Intro vector:** Cold-accepting (Chris Smith runs Female Founder Office Hours = public sourcing); warm via their portfolio or Kauffman Fellows network.
- **Red flags for Alche:** Only 6 investments per year = very selective. No obvious wellness portfolio beat to leverage for warm intros.
- **Fit score: 7/10** — worth approaching given Smith's HealthTech interest and their pre-seed-pure positioning.

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10. LocalGlobe / Phoenix Court (Latitude, Solar)

- **Website:** https://www.phoenixcourt.vc/localglobe (redirected from localglobe.vc — Phoenix Court is the new umbrella)

- **Check:** Pre-seed £250k–£1m; seed £500k–£2m (LG commonly leads). Latitude handles growth-stage follow-on.
- **Thesis:** "Cradle-to-IPO" long-term backing. Sector-agnostic but trend-aware — fintech, healthtech, deep tech, consumer, marketplaces, AI, blockchain.
- **Consumer/wellness fit:** Partial. Consumer exposure historically (Citymapper, Secret Escapes, Graze, Moo) but more recent activity has been fintech/infra-heavy (Wise, Monzo, Improbable, Tessian, Zego, YuLife, Qogita, Sylvera).
- **Key partners:**
- **Saul Klein** — co-founder, Managing Partner, Phoenix Court. Ex-Index, LoveFilm founder. UK tech statesman; unlikely first point of contact for pre-seed.
- **Robin Klein** — co-founder, long-time UK angel (Lastminute, Tweetdeck, Zoopla, MoneySupermarket).
- **Ophelia Brown** — General Partner (also runs Blossom Capital separately; verify current role at LocalGlobe).
- **Emma Phillips** — Investment Partner, B2B/AI/future-of-work focus.
- **George Henry de Frahan** — Early-stage investor, likely best pre-seed contact.
- **Intro vector:** Warm via Phoenix Court family of funds (Latitude, Solar, Basecamp). Connected to seemingly every UK tech founder — intros are plentiful if you're in-network.
- **Red flags for Alche:** No obvious recent wellness/DTC bets. Fintech lean is clear. Need to lead with content platform + AI angle to avoid fintech frame.
- **Fit score: 7/10** — strong signal but need the right partner.

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11. Seedcamp

- **Website:** https://seedcamp.com (verified, active)
- **Check:** Lead rounds from angel through seed, typically up to $1m; will participate up to Series B
- **Thesis:** Sector-agnostic European seed platform. Partner podcast introducing Fund VI emphasizes AI, developer tools, cybersecurity, **health tech**, fintech. Historically avoids capital-intensive categories.
- **Consumer/wellness fit:** Partial. Health portfolio: Lindus Health, Function Health, Peppy, La Fraise (dental AI). Some consumer: Vinterior. 2026 new checks include Topograph, Lupin & Holmes.
- **Key partners:**
- **Reshma Sohoni** — Co-founder & Managing Partner since 2007. INSEAD MBA, Vodafone eVentures India background. Based in London. 120+ investments made.
- **Carlos Espinal** — Managing Partner
- **Tom Wilson** — Partner
- **Sia Houchangnia** — Partner, ESADE/Kent + EY/UBS. Based in London.
- **Intro vector:** Active "Pitch Us" inbound form on site. Seedcamp Week events are a traditional entry. Strong European founder network.
- **Red flags for Alche:** Portfolio skews software-platform not DTC-brand. Alche's supplement-commerce side may read as too "physical goods" for their software-preferred thesis. Lead with the AI/app/platform angle.
- **Fit score: 7/10** — credible but frame as software/platform, not CPG.

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12. Passion Capital

- **Website:** https://www.passioncapital.com (verified, active)
- **Check:** £250k–£1m pre-seed (they famously invest with "no need for product or customers")
- **Fund size:** Fund IV LP established April 2024, actively deploying
- **Thesis:** "Outstanding European founders" in AI, FinTech & Risk. Fund IV materials highlighted consumer investments (Butternut Box).
- **Consumer/wellness fit:** Partial. **Butternut Box** (subscription dog meals) is a strong DTC consumer reference. Marshmallow (digital insurance). But portfolio is mostly fintech (Monzo, GoCardless, Tide, Lendable, Smarkets, Ravelin, Adzuna, PolyAI).
- **Key partners:**
- **Eileen Burbidge MBE** — co-founder, Treasury fintech envoy, ex-Skype. Very public.
- **Robert Dighero** — co-founder/Partner
- **Andrew Jenkins** — Partner

- (Stefan Glaenzer departed 2018.)
- **Intro vector:** Warm via Monzo/GoCardless/Butternut network. Burbidge is active in fintech ecosystem but accessible at events.
- **Red flags for Alche:** Fintech-weighted portfolio; wellness is a stretch. Burbidge's fintech-envoy focus means consumer deals less top-of-mind. Butternut Box is lone strong consumer reference.
- **Fit score: 6/10** — backup option, lead with AI angle.

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13. Moonfire Ventures

- **Website:** https://moonfire.com (note: founded 2020 by ex-Atomico Mattias Ljungman)
- **Check:** $100k–$5m, sweet spot $1.5m
- **Fund size:** $60m Fund I, $115m Fund II
- **Thesis:** Data-driven pre-seed/seed — claims to screen 50,000 companies/week via proprietary ML. Four focus areas: future of work, capital & finance, gaming & community, and **health & wellbeing**.
- **Consumer/wellness fit:** Partial but credible. Led Oliva (employee mental health) pre-seed. Recent 2026 deal: Eunice ($8m seed, due-diligence AI). Portfolio leans software-platform but health & wellbeing is explicit.
- **Key partner: Mattias Ljungman** — co-founder Atomico, launched Moonfire 2020. Institutional pedigree + technical/AI bent.
- **Intro vector:** Likely receptive to cold inbound with strong data; data-driven thesis means founders with traction metrics get noticed.
- **Red flags for Alche:** Their AI-driven sourcing rewards founders with quantifiable early signal — Alche must have traction data (waitlist numbers, engagement metrics) to stand out. Health portfolio is thinner than Calm/Storm or Ada.
- **Fit score: 7/10** — good backup fit; bring data.

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14. Connect Ventures

- **Website:** https://www.connectventures.co (verified, active)
- **Check:** $500k–$5m pre-seed through seed
- **Thesis:** "Product founders" — obsessive user focus, opinionated, designed for defensibility. Sectors: AI, cybersecurity, deep tech, data, fintech, **health**, vertical networks.
- **Consumer/wellness fit:** Partial. Health is an explicit sector. Portfolio is more platform/infra (TrueLayer, Dust, Aikido, Plain, Mosaico) than consumer-brand.
- **Key partners:**
- **Pietro Bezza** — Managing Partner
- **Sitar Teli** — Managing Partner
- **Rory Stirling** — General Partner
- **Intro vector:** Warm via TrueLayer/Citymapper founders; their "Built By Few" product summit is a sourcing venue.
- **Red flags for Alche:** Heavy B2B software lean despite "health" listing. Alche's consumer-membership model is outside their typical pattern.
- **Fit score: 6/10** — frame strongly as product-craft story.

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15. Kindred Capital

- **Website:** https://kindredcapital.vc (verified, active)
- **Check:** £500k–£2m, seed-focused, partner-only decision-making
- **Fund size:** £81m seed fund (most recent disclosed)
- **Thesis:** "Equitable venture" — every founder becomes a co-owner of the fund (gets carry). Generalist pre-seed/seed, mission-driven. Latest investments: Cakewalk, Sohar Health.
- **Consumer/wellness fit:** Partial. Generalist portfolio: RobCo (robotics), Cradle (drug-design AI), Lottie (care home marketplace — has aging/care angle). Not a thematic wellness fund but has life-sciences exposure.
- **Key partners:**
- **Leila Zegna** — co-founding GP. Bain → MBA HBS → Silicon Valley → London. Likely most accessible partner.

- **Mark Evans** — co-founding GP
- **Chrys Chrysanthou** — GP
- **Maria Palma** — GP
- **John Cassidy** — GP
- **Intro vector:** Warm via Cradle / Lottie / RobCo founders; partner-level outreach encouraged. The equitable model self-selects for founder-first dealflow.
- **Red flags for Alche:** Generalist with no clear wellness/DTC portfolio anchor. Lottie (care home marketplace) closest reference but narrow.
- **Fit score: 6/10** — credible generalist option.

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16. Concept Ventures

- **Website:** https://concept.vc (redirect from conceptventures.vc)
- **Check:** Up to $1.5m pre-seed
- **Fund size:** $88m Fund II recently announced
- **Thesis:** Pre-seed pure-play. "Pre-seed was never a placeholder. It's the point." 70% of portfolio founders have become LPs in the fund.
- **Consumer/wellness fit:** Partial. Highest-profile wins are AI infra (ElevenLabs $11bn, Treefera $130m+, Anam, Vsim) — skews AI/B2B rather than consumer/wellness.
- **Key partners:**
- **Reece Chowdhry** — Founder/Managing Partner
- **Oliver Kicks** — Partner
- **Jeff Chowdhry, Seyon Indran, Ariel Rahamim, Anrea Munsamy** — investment team
- **Intro vector:** Founders-backing-founders model — warm via any portfolio CEO.
- **Red flags for Alche:** AI/enterprise-leaning recent deals; their portfolio stars are all deep-tech / AI infra, not consumer. Alche would be a thesis stretch unless framed strongly as AI-native.
- **Fit score: 6/10** — frame as AI-native longevity platform.

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17. Felix Capital

- **Website:** https://www.felixcap.com (verified, active)
- **Check:** Typically seed through growth — **likely too late stage for a €500K pre-seed round**. $600m Fund IV.
- **Thesis:** "Venture for the creative class" — intersection of technology and creativity; lifestyle, brands, content.
- **Consumer/wellness fit: Yes thematically.** Portfolio: **Goop, Peloton, Oatly, Deliveroo, Farfetch, Peppy Health, Papier, Castore, AKT London, Anine Bing, Lassie.** Goop in particular is the closest analogue to Alche's wellness-content-commerce model.
- **Key partner:**
- **Frederic Court** — founder, 2015. Was at Advent Venture Partners. Very active on LinkedIn and events.
- **Intro vector:** Warm via Peppy, Goop, Papier, AKT London founders. Felix partners regularly attend and speak at B2C Bacchanal (London consumer VC event).
- **Red flags for Alche: Stage mismatch for €500K pre-seed.** Felix typically writes $5m+ into companies with revenue traction. Keep warm for Seed+/Series A conversation in 12 months. Right now, they'd likely route Alche to smaller funds in their network.
- **Fit score: 6/10 for pre-seed, 10/10 for Series A** — build relationship now, pitch later.

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18. Hoxton Ventures

- **Website:** https://hoxtonventures.com (verified, active)
- **Check:** $500k–$5m pre-seed through Series A
- **Thesis:** "European venture with a Silicon Valley mindset." Deliberately anti-thematic — backs founders building new market categories. Emphasizes US expansion and upside over risk-minimization.

- **Consumer/wellness fit:** Weak. Some consumer (Deliveroo historical, FINESSE fashion, Lumi) but overall portfolio is 60%+ B2B/enterprise (XYZ Reality, Peptone, Spacelift, Darktrace, Preply).
- **Key partners:**
- **Hussein Kanji** — founding Partner, ex-Accel, very public on Twitter/podcasts
- **Bryan Gartner** — recent hire from Khosla Ventures (US expansion)
- **Intro vector:** Kanji is highly accessible on Twitter and active in ecosystem. Warm via Deliveroo / Darktrace alumni networks.
- **Red flags for Alche:** Kanji has publicly stated skepticism of "pattern matching" and emphasizes breakthroughs — but portfolio is B2B-heavy. Consumer-wellness is off-pattern.
- **Fit score: 4/10** — possible but not priority.

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19. firstminute Capital

- **Website:** https://firstminute.capital (verified, active — footer reads "© 2026")
- **Check:** £1m–£3m pre-seed
- **Thesis:** "Era-defining technology" — deep tech, AI, developer tools, SaaS, fintech, healthtech. Backed by 130+ unicorn-founder LPs.
- **Consumer/wellness fit:** Weak. Healthtech exposure is B2B (Nabla, Lindus Health, Relation) not consumer-wellness. Deep-tech lean is strong.
- **Key partners:**
- **Brent Hoberman** — co-founder (Lastminute, Founders Factory, MADE.com)
- **Henry Lane Fox** — co-founder
- **Spencer Crawley** — General Partner
- **Intro vector:** Huge unicorn-founder network — warm intros are the only viable route.
- **Red flags for Alche:** Deep-tech + developer-tools bias. Consumer-wellness is off-thesis unless framed as AI-native platform.
- **Fit score: 4/10** — skip unless warm intro materializes.

Funds Deprioritised / Off-Thesis

Entrepreneur First (EF) — https://joinef.com. Matt Clifford stepped back as CEO April 2026, Alice Bentinck now CEO. $1.3bn valuation raise 2026. Business model is **talent investing pre-company**: they select individuals before they have a cofounder or idea, then run a 12-week FORM program to build a cofounding team. This is the **wrong format for Timu**, who is a solo founder with an existing operating company in Berlin. EF would effectively ask Alche to dissolve into a new cofounding pairing. Skip. **Fit: 3/10.**

Episode 1 Ventures — https://episode1.com. Explicitly **B2B software only**: 73% of portfolio reaches Series A but the companies are Adsum (tax refunds), Sano Genetics, CloudNC, Raft (freight). Consumer/DTC is not in thesis. Skip. **Fit: 2/10.**

Forward Partners (UK) — team of 3 as of recent data, wound down Forward Advances (revenue-based financing) in 2022, no confirmed new fund announcements. Treat as **inactive / unverified** for 2026 new-money purposes. Not to be confused with **Forward Consumer Partners** (separate US firm, unrelated, $500m Fund II closed March 2026 — but they write $25m–$250m majority equity, irrelevant for Alche pre-seed).

Iris Ventures — Barcelona-HQ, London-connected. Recently closed €100m of €200m Fund II targeting beauty / **wellness / nutrition / longevity / conscious living**. Thesis is a near-perfect match for Alche, BUT check size is €5m–€20m per company at growth stage. **Stage mismatch for €500K pre-seed — keep warm for Series A.** Partners: Montse Suarez (founder).

Top 5 for Alche

1. **Ada Ventures** — healthy aging is literally one of three fund themes; Check Warner + Matt Penneycard have both built publicly around preventative health and inclusive access. The thesis doc writes itself. Pre-seed check size fits exactly.
2. **JamJar Investments** — Innocent founders' fund, UK's deepest DTC wellness portfolio (Wild, SURI, Runna, Healf). Healf overlap needs pre-clearing, but if they lean in, they are the highest-signal ecosystem partner in London for a content-commerce longevity play.

3. **Cherry Ventures** — Berlin HQ + London partner (Dinika Mahtani) + Zalando consumer DNA + perfect check size. Lowest friction given Timu is Berlin-based; Filip Dames is the warm route via Berlin networks.
4. **V3 Ventures / dmg ventures (joint 4th)** — V3 lists "functional supplements" explicitly; dmg just led Equi (women's wellness supplements) and offers unmatched UK media distribution. Both frequently co-invest (SURI deal), so a single thread can unlock both.
5. **Eka Ventures** — preventative-healthcare impact thesis aligned almost verbatim with Alche; Camilla Dolan's background backing Bloom & Wild + Gousto means she understands consumer + science blends. Pitch must lead with impact, not commerce.

Sources

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- Cherry team page
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- Octopus Ventures Rebecca Hunt profile
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- Playfair $70m Fund III (Fund II history; Fund III confirmed March 2023 per search)
- LocalGlobe / Phoenix Court
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- Seedcamp $180M Fund VI
- Passion Capital
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